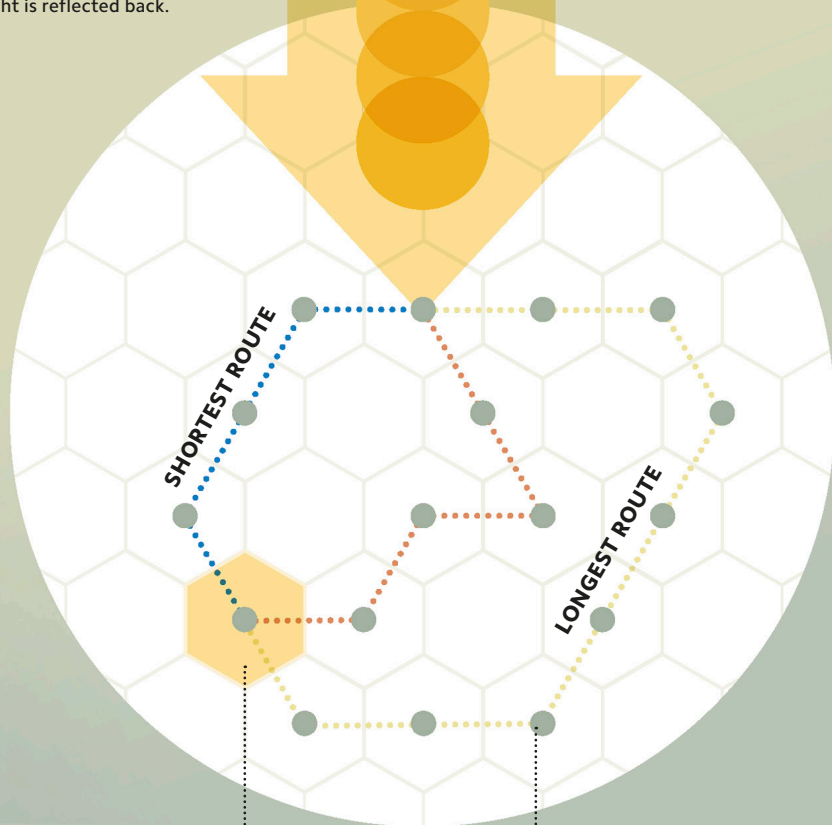


PHOTONS

Incoming light carries energy corresponding to its color. Chromophores can be excited by high-energy violet and blue photons and low-energy red ones, but midrange green light is reflected back.



Changes to pigments produce separated positive and negative ions, creating an "electrochemical potential" that can trigger other reactions.

**REACTION
CENTER**

**LIGHT-COLLECTING
MOLECULES**

Energy is transferred via neighboring chromophores to the reaction center with high efficiency. Each molecule in the chain is always ready to receive the energy in turn, so it is suggested that quantum phenomena aid the cells in finding the most efficient paths.